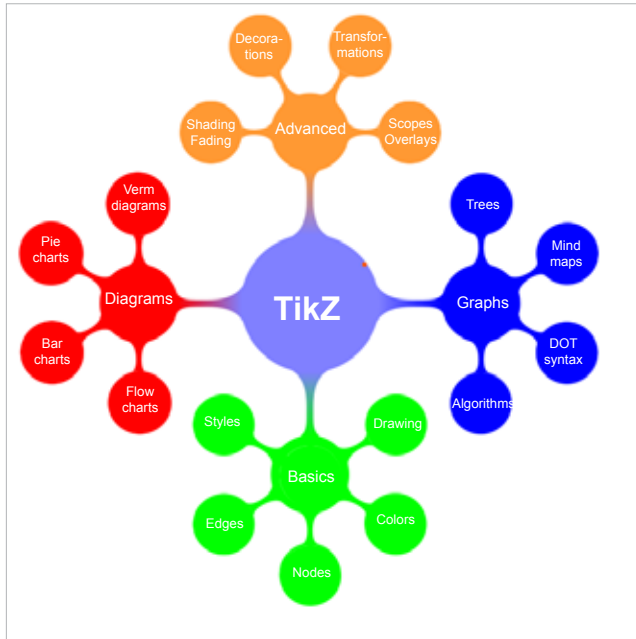
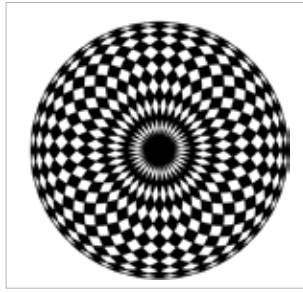




Some of the art created with TikZ

dimensions for visualising your ideas and data.... you can quickly start with TikZ and enjoy its many benefits.”

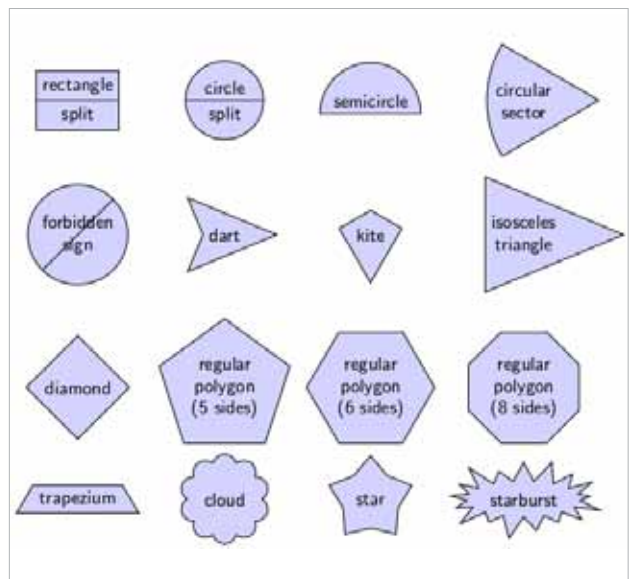
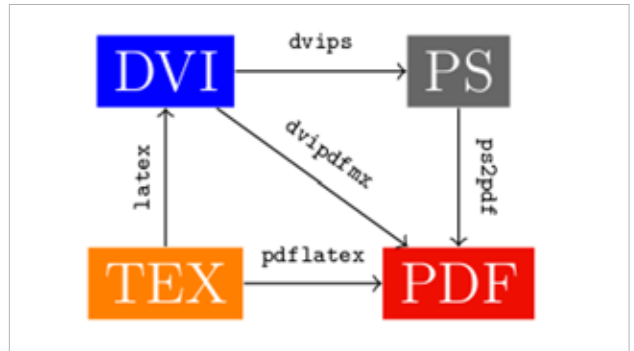
Topics you come across in this book come in a wide range — how to create objects ranging from angles to arcs, arrows, arrow tips, ball shading, background layers, bar charts, colour maps, flowcharts, loops, mind maps, pie charts, rectangles, ticks, and transparencies.

Believe it or not, this tool can also help create jigsaw puzzles.

To get the most out of this book, you need a TeX installation (either TeX live, MiKTeX, or MacTeX). If you don't wish to install LaTeX, you can go to tikz.org. This has an online compiler. Besides, the helpful overleaf.com helps to compile examples that you get on GitHub or tikz.org.

You get the code to try out concepts, which can be downloaded from GitHub. You can even open the entire code bundle by opening it in overleaf.com.

Overleaf has been described as “a collaborative cloud-based LaTeX editor used for writing, editing and publishing scientific documents.” It is very simple and interesting to use — check it out online.



This book is written in a way that makes it easy to follow. Starting with small circles and simple objects, it takes you to some rather complex designs. Slowly, you begin realising what a powerful tool this could be.

If the reader is not too deep into design or publishing, he or she can just skim through, and zoom in on those sections that are of closer interest to one's work. That should suffice, as the book also helps to work with snippets of code.

Some online links are helpful, like for accessing libraries from Cisco or Hewlett Packard (the hardware giants), which can be used in TikZ too.

FOSS tools are often seen as lacking good documentation. Books like this one fill a vital gap. **END** 🐼

By: Frederick Noronha

The author is a Goa-based freelance journalist, who has been tracking FOSS (free and open source software), Creative Commons and the Wikipedia issues closely and intensely for a long time.